the first ruler to unify both Upper Burma and Lower Burma and extended Burmese suzerainty over neighboring Shan states and Arakan. Between 1057 and 1059 Anawrahta led his army to the kingdom of Nan-Chou in search of the Buddha's tooth relic. During his reign Anawrahta transformed Bagan into the religious and cultural center of Southeast Asia. He converted to Therāvāda Buddhism and made it the state religion of Bagan. Anawrahta built numerous pagodas during his reign. He also established contact with Ceylon and received a copy of the complete Tripitaka, which was placed in the Shwedagon pagoda in Bagan.

Aung Gyi (1919–). As a soldier in the Fourth Burma Rifles, he rose to the rank of brigadier general and was member of the Revolutionary Council. Aung Gyi became an outspoken critic of the government of Ne Win during the August 8, 1988, uprising.

Aung Gyi rose to prominence as the leading military administrator in the caretaker government of 1958–1960, coconspirator in the coup d'état of March 2, 1962, and member of the following Revolutionary Council. Forced to resign from the Revolutionary Council, Aung Gyi was imprisoned from 1965 to 1968 and then again from 1973 to 1974. Following his later release, he returned to private life. He was imprisoned again in 1988 following the publication of four open letters to Ne Win in which he criticized the “Burmese Way to Socialism” and warned of social unrest in Myanmar. He joined the Aung-Suu-Tin coalition and became president of the National League for Democracy (NLD) following the State Law and Order Restoration Council's (SLORC) seizure of power on September 18, 1988. He later resigned from the NLD on December 3, 1988, to form the Union Nationals Democracy Party.

Aung ‘Kyi (1946–). He is a retired major general of the Myanmar Army, and is currently the minister of labor and holds a concurrent appointment minister of social welfare, relief and settlement in the government of Myanmar. He graduated from the Officers Training School and went on to serve as deputy minister for labor in November 2006. He was appointed